

GROWTH MARKETING · CASE STUDY

Swift Restoration

Engineering a low-authority local operator to win emergency leads in a franchise-dominated market

Client: Swift Restoration LLC · theswiftrestoration.com · Boone, Iowa

Scope: Greenfield SEO build • local strategy • paid-media restructure • WordPress → .NET migration

THE THESIS

Swift's site targets no keyword today — so this is a greenfield build, not an optimization. The platform migration is the moment to build clean. And the competitive war for a DR 3.2 operator is the Google Map Pack and Local Services Ads, not backlink parity with national franchises — so the plan wins Boone and Ames first, on the levers that convert: reviews, local pages, and emergency-intent paid.

The engagement

Swift Restoration is a credible, owner-operated emergency-restoration company in Boone, Iowa with a near-perfect reputation (5.0★ on 15 Google reviews) and almost no digital footprint to match it. The homepage targets no keyword, there are no service or location pages, and 'Projects' are unlabeled photo galleries. In parallel, the business is migrating from WordPress to a custom **.NET** platform.

That combination is the opportunity: rather than optimize an existing asset, we build one from zero, on a new platform, with a clean technical foundation — and concentrate effort where a local operator can actually win.

Diagnostic snapshot (measured)

Signal	Finding
Homepage title tag	Placeholder — “This site is used to help customers look into our company.” Zero keywords.
Service pages	None — service cards link to '#’.
Location pages	None — the 8 counties are unlinked text.
Crawl	~93 URLs, mostly WordPress image-attachment pages; 42 noindex (24.85%).
Templating	Gutenverse plugin → duplicate titles / H1s / meta across ~51 URLs.
Authority	Domain Rating 3.2 (Ahrefs).
Reputation	5.0★ on 15 Google reviews — a strong, under-leveraged asset.
Paid	2 generic Search ads; live ‘&’ encoding bug; no LSA presence.

Competitor authority — why links are the wrong fight

The field is bimodal. Among the independents Swift actually competes with, it already sits ahead of 515 Restoration and the SERVPRO-of-Ames microsite. The franchise ‘strength’ is borrowed from corporate domains (DR 63–76) and unbeatable on links — so the plan competes on local relevance, reviews, and LSA instead.

Competitor	DR	Read
Swift Restoration	3.2	Mid-pack among the true independents.
Dream Steam	15.0	Strongest independent; the one real authority gap.
515 Restoration	0.0	Beatable on fundamentals.
SERVPRO of Ames (microsite)	0.8	If it ranks here, Swift already leads on authority.
SERVPRO / ServiceMaster / Restoration 1 (corporate)	76 / 72 / 63	Borrowed authority — not winnable on links.

Strategy — five pillars

01 Build, don't optimize

Treat the .NET migration as the build vehicle: ship a scalable service × location architecture, unique template-level metadata, schema, and a real internal-linking model — fixing the duplicate-metadata and crawl-bloat issues at the root, while protecting equity with a rigorous 301 map.

02 Win home turf first

Boone and Ames before the saturated Des Moines metro — lower competition, higher conversion likelihood. Out-build SERVPRO of Ames's templated town pages with genuinely local content.

03 Map Pack & LSA over links

For a low-authority emergency business, local-pack visibility and Local Services Ads drive the calls. Open the LSA channel (highest-ROI, pay-per-lead) once GBP verification is confirmed.

04 A review engine

Swift's 5.0★ reputation is its strongest latent asset. A systematic review-request workflow compounds local rankings and conversion simultaneously — the single highest-leverage lever.

05 Measure outcomes, not rankings

Stand up GA4 + call tracking + GSC so every channel is judged on cost-per-qualified-call. Prioritize keywords by revenue potential, not search volume.

Month-1 execution

Week	Focus
1	Migration SEO spec + 301 map; rewrite homepage title/meta/H1; fix the Google Ads bug + consolidate to 2–3 campaigns; stand up GA4 + call tracking + GSC.
2	GBP optimization + verification; launch the review-request engine; begin citation/NAP cleanup; resolve the duplicate-domain question.
3	Ship Water + Emergency service pillars and Boone + Ames location pages (schema, click-to-call).
4	Launch LSA in Boone/Ames; matched landing pages live; capture baseline KPIs.

How success is measured

KPI	Baseline	30-day	90-day
Tracked phone calls	not yet tracked	tracking live	upward trend
Organic + LSA leads	not yet tracked	LSA live + baseline	upward trend
Reviews (count / rating)	15 / 5.0★	25 / ≥4.9★	45+ / ≥4.9★
Local-pack rank (Boone/Ames)	~none	entering	top-3 (Boone core)
Indexed real pages	~7	~10	~17+
Domain Rating	3.2	maintain	slight ↑

Methodology & data note

This case study separates **measured data** (site crawl, Ahrefs Domain Rating, GBP reviews, Google Ads Transparency Center) from clearly-labelled **estimate bands** (keyword volume) and **to-be-baselined** metrics (organic traffic, impressions, conversions — established via the analytics stack). Exact search-volume and competitor traffic figures require a paid data tier not active in this phase; they are added when access is restored.

Full 20-section documentation and the underlying competitor and keyword deliverables accompany this summary in the [GitHub case-study repository](#).